

TAIM: Compute as Currency

—The Online Payment Protocol for the AI Era

Introduction: What is TAIM

TAIM is a decentralized financial protocol. It creates a native currency for the computing power of the AI era.

Its core mechanism is remarkably simple: take the idle, soon-to-be-discarded Tokens and dormant computing power of the AI industry, lock them as collateral through smart contracts, and mint them into a circulating currency—TAIM.

- Minters: Stake idle computing power and Tokens into the pool to mint TAIM.
- Users: Use TAIM to exchange for real computing power at affordable prices to run their own AI models.
- Speculators: Trade TAIM on secondary markets, injecting liquidity into the system and taking on the function of price discovery.

The price of TAIM will not rise indefinitely, because the total global computing power is finite—physical scarcity caps its ceiling. The price of TAIM will also not fall to zero, because when the coin price drops below API retail prices, real AI developers will step in to buy, redeem, and use it—real demand floors its value.

When speculators exit, they summon users to enter. When users consume, they pave the way for speculators to return. These two forces no longer prey upon each other; they become alternating pistons in a single engine, delivering powerful liquidity.

TAIM is not a traditional cryptocurrency project. It is the online payment of the AI era—the sole financial conduit that allows capital to flow correctly within the AI industry.

I. De-Instrumentalization: The Fundamental Way Out for AI

Why is the birth of TAIM inevitable? Because it answers a fundamental question that all AI companies have been evading.

Everyone teaching you how to monetize AI is teaching you how to instrumentalize it. Have AI write copy. Have AI make slides. Have AI diagnose illnesses. This path is not wrong. But its fatal flaw is this: it treats AI as a sharper hoe, then expects this hoe to rapidly grow crops on existing land that can cover its astronomical costs. But the fertility of the land is finite, and the speed of industrial adoption is slow. A hoe built with hundreds of billions of dollars cannot possibly produce enough to cover its investment.

TAIM offers another path: let AI itself develop into a second form—de-instrumentalize it. Let it become the field itself.

Not to have AI serve other industries, but to make AI itself an asset class that can be financialized, monetized, and directly traded by global capital. TAIM was born for this.

Financialization first, instrumentalization second. This is the only correct sequence of implementation for the AI industry.

II. The Background of TAIM's Birth: The True Lesson of the Internet Bubble

The birth of TAIM is rooted in a historical lesson that spans over two decades.

In 1999, the Internet bubble reached its peak. Capital poured frantically into any company with a ".com" suffix, believing that technology itself could create infinite wealth. Then, the bubble burst. Countless companies evaporated, and trillions of dollars disappeared.

But the Internet did not die. It survived and ultimately reshaped the entire world. Why?

Because what truly survived that bubble was not the portal websites that simply burned cash, but an infrastructure that enabled capital to flow correctly: online payment.

PayPal and Alipay first moved money online safely, flexibly, and legitimately. Only then did all e-commerce, social networking, and O2O have a foundation to exist. Capital found its conduit, and the Internet truly landed. It was not the maturation of technology that gave birth to financial tools; it was the financial tools landing first that gave technology the possibility to survive.

This is the bloody lesson that the Internet bubble bought with the evaporation of trillions of

dollars.

Capital must first find its conduit. Only then can industry be irrigated.

What TAIM sets out to do is precisely to lay down this conduit for the AI industry.

III. The Problem TAIM Solves: AI's Bubble, More Dangerous Than the Internet's

In 2026, the AI industry is repeating the mistakes of 1999. But this time, the situation is far worse.

3.1 An Unprecedented Flood of Capital

On April 29, 2026, four American tech giants—Google, Microsoft, Meta, and Amazon—disclosed their latest earnings almost simultaneously. Reading these four reports together, one fact surfaces: the market's biggest concern is no longer "whether there is demand for AI," but rather, "once demand is confirmed, who can convert it into revenue faster, and who will be choked first by computing power and capital expenditure."

The annual capital expenditure guidance for the four giants is as follows:

- Microsoft: Full-year capex guidance of approximately \$190 billion, with the CFO explicitly stating that computing power supply will remain tight at least through the end of 2026.
- Amazon: Capex of approximately \$200 billion, yet its operating cash flow is only about \$178 billion—cash generated from its core business can no longer cover investment, necessitating debt issuance and other means to supplement funding, essentially beginning to experience net cash outflow.
- Google: Full-year capex raised to \$180 – 190 billion, a year-on-year increase of 108%.
- Meta: Full-year capex raised to \$125 – 145 billion, a year-on-year increase of approximately 75%.

Combined total of the four: approximately \$700 billion, a 165% increase from the \$245 billion of 2024. This sum exceeds the GDP of Israel.

3.2 Staggering Losses: The More They Earn, The More They Lose

The vast majority of this astronomical capital has flowed—in a distorted and pathological manner—into AI chip companies led by Nvidia. But among these AI infrastructure companies, profitability tells a different story:

OpenAI boasts 960 million monthly active users, annualized revenue as high as \$25 billion, and a valuation reaching \$852 billion. Yet behind the glossy numbers lies the brutal reality of burning \$57 billion a year with a net loss of \$44 billion. Its 2026 inference costs reached \$14.1 billion, accounting for 47% of revenue; gross margin has dropped from 40% to 33%, and the breakeven target has been pushed back to 2030.

Anthropic faces similar challenges: annualized revenue has surpassed \$30 billion, exceeding OpenAI's \$25 billion over the same period. Yet the company is projected to lose \$14 billion in 2026, with the timeline for turning cash flow positive pushed back to 2030.

This is highly reminiscent of the Internet bubble of 2000, when 86% of listed Internet companies were unprofitable—but the individual loss scale of AI companies far exceeds that of any Internet company back then.

3.3 Industrial Chain Imbalance: Profits at the Base, Bloodletting at the Top

The profit distribution across the entire AI industry chain exhibits extreme structural imbalance.

Nvidia — the undisputed hegemon of AI chips — recorded full-year revenue for fiscal 2026 of \$215.9 billion, a year-on-year increase of 65%; net profit reached a staggering \$120.067 billion, also up 65% year-on-year. Of this, data center business revenue for the full year reached \$193.7 billion, contributing nearly 90% of the company's total revenue. Full-year gross margin remained steady at the industry-ceiling level of 71.1%. In the fourth quarter alone, net profit reached approximately \$43 billion, equivalent to an average daily net profit exceeding \$300 million.

Goldman Sachs pointed out in its Q1 2026 analysis report that the core contradiction in the AI investment narrative has undergone a fundamental shift. Previously, the dominant focus of market discussion was "whether the scale of capital expenditure is excessive"; now, investors are more concerned with: when and how these expenditures will translate into visible revenue growth and free cash flow. The current ratio of capital expenditure to revenue in the AI industry stands at a staggering 6:1. This means that for every 6 dollars the giants invest, they generate only 1 dollar of AI revenue.

At the same time, the contradiction between computing power supply and demand is intensifying at an unprecedented rate. Data from the China Academy of Information and Communications Technology shows that in Q1 2026, domestic AI computing power demand surged 417% year-on-year, while supply growth was only 128%, with the annual gap continuing to widen. This supply-demand imbalance is driving computing power prices up across the board: overseas H100 rental prices have risen 40% within five months, and the Blackwell series has seen an increase of 48%. Computing power has evolved from an ordinary production factor into a strategic resource with scarcity attributes.

3.4 Quantitative Comparison with the Internet Bubble

The comparison between the current AI bubble and the Internet bubble has sparked widespread discussion within the industry. Technology strategist and financial expert Igor Pejic notes that the similarities include disruptive technology, collaboration and financing agreements among major players, the expansion of network infrastructure, and "extremely high" valuations. Hou Shengli, CTO of Cisco Greater China, also assesses that the current development trajectory of AI is highly similar to the Internet bubble period of 2000, and that after the bubble, a true flourishing of applications is about to arrive.

But there is a critical question: can the flourishing arrive before the bubble fully bursts? ChatGPT has already partnered with sovereign states like Malta—this is a terrifying signal. The emotions of capital and the market have been suppressed to a breaking point, desperately needing monetization, desperately needing to see the splash from these astronomical sums thrown into the water. Think about it: who would willingly take on political risk just to secure a piece of scaled monetization revenue?

3.5 The Market's Awakening: From "Burn Narrative" to "Return Trial"

In 2026, the capital market's patience is running out. In the past, capital expenditure was largely seen as "investment for future growth"; now, investors are beginning to pay more direct attention to what these investments mean for current performance. The market is shifting from "rewarding Capex" to "scrutinizing Capex."

Following the latest round of earnings releases, aside from Meta, the stock prices of Google, Microsoft, and Amazon generally fell. Since its earnings release, Microsoft has dropped more than 20%. Moody's even predicted a bubble-bursting scenario: in some quarter of 2026, once AI revenue growth disappoints, panic selling will trigger a 25% stock market crash, evaporating \$20 trillion.

Bloomberg data shows that the free cash flow expectations of several tech giants have been continuously revised downward. After raising capital expenditure, Google's free cash flow is projected to plummet from \$73.3 billion to approximately \$8.2 billion; Meta's free cash flow is rapidly declining from \$54 billion in 2024 to approximately \$20 billion. Book profits are growing, but the real "money in hand" is shrinking.

Here, we see a complete and brutal closed loop: colossal amounts of capital have flooded into the AI industry, yet cannot find a path to flow back. Capital has profited handsomely on the "picks and shovels," but continues to bleed on the "entities." This system is approaching its breaking point.

IV. The Absurdity TAIM Will End: The Golden Rabbit

Faced with such a massive capital black hole, the entire AI industry is collectively maintaining an absurd delusion: that the revenue from instrumentalized monetization will be sufficient to cover the astronomical capital expenditure.

The AI giants are missile builders. They have burned hundreds of billions of dollars to build the ultimate weapon capable of destroying the old world — Artificial General Intelligence. But they don't know how to use this missile to wage a war that can cover its costs. So, they sell this missile to users—hunters lured by advertisements and free trials.

The hunters take the missiles and go rabbit hunting. Write some copy. Generate a video. Make a slideshow. The missile builders believe that as long as the hunters' returns can cover the cost of the missile (the revenue from AI instrumentalized monetization can cover subscription fees), countless people will come to buy missiles, and they will recoup their costs. To this end, they frantically increase the missile's firepower — from GPT-3 to GPT-5, from tens of billions of parameters to trillions.

But they never ask the fundamental question: In this world right now, is there any rabbit worth such a missile?

No. This is the cruelest answer. Currently, there is no AI instrumentalization application scenario —writing copy, making slides, generating short videos—that can generate enough revenue, that can allow the immeasurable cost of user subscription packages to cover those hundreds of billions of dollars in capital expenditure. The case of Sora is the most brutal: its API pricing was as high as \$30 per minute, while competing products' costs were only \$8 to \$1.2. The cost premium reached two to three times. User growth stalled. Annual revenue was just over \$2 million, with virtually no effective paying users. The technology was impressive, but the economics didn't add up. Ultimately, OpenAI announced the shutdown of Sora in early 2026.

The missile builders may understand this logic. But they have no other choice. This is the absurdity that TAIM will end: using missiles to hunt rabbits. At least for now, there is no phenomenon-level industry or application that can connect to AI at scale, with high consensus, and with speed. I do not deny that the instrumentalization of AI is an inevitable trend, but at present, this trend is wrong. The emotions of capital are suppressed, and so is the market. The silver lining is that "storage" exists to persuade real money to wait a little longer, but patience is ultimately limited. How long will it take for this indefinitely delayed outlet to appear? Can these astronomical sums afford to wait?

V. Conclusion: To the Future That is About to Arrive

We are standing at a tipping point.

The financial system of the old world can no longer accommodate the new species that is AI. The pipes of fiat currency are too narrow, the monetization of industry is too slow, and the patience of capital has burned to the end. The grotesque reality of using missiles to hunt rabbits must be terminated.

Goldman Sachs' latest report has sent a clear signal: the logic of AI investment is shifting from "how much are you burning" to "when will the returns materialize." The market is beginning to focus more on free cash flow, profit margins, and AI revenue conversion paths. Companies that can clearly demonstrate AI monetization capability are receiving higher valuations, while those with vague return logic are significantly underperforming.

TAIM is not here to patch up the old world. It is here to install a heart for AI—this civilization destined to sprint on computing power. A financial heart driven by computing power, guaranteed by consensus, and never resting.

Let capital run first, then let it run to the right place. Above all, it cannot be allowed to stall.

TAIM: Tokenized AI Money

My contact email address is: 2080386202@QQ.com

I welcome anyone to send me an email to discuss and communicate at any time.

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Data Sources: Goldman Sachs, Bloomberg, Microsoft/Google/Meta/Amazon Q1 2026 Earnings Reports, Nvidia FY2026 Annual Report, OpenAI/Anthropic Public Financial Data, China Academy of Information and Communications Technology, 36Kr, Caixin, and other public sources. Data as of May 18, 2026.